

THE RESCUE PATTERN

The Help vs. Rescue Filter

Three questions to run before you jump in

Helping is fine. Rescuing is the trap. The difference isn't the action — it's what's driving it. Same favor, same words, completely different engine underneath. Before you step in, run these three.

1

Did they actually ask?

Or did you appoint yourself? Unrequested help is usually about you, not them.

2

Can they do this themselves?

Every rep you take is a rep they don't get. Your help can quietly keep them small.

3

Do I need them to need me right now?

The honest one. Be truthful about what you're getting out of it.

If they didn't ask, they could do it themselves, and part of you needs to be needed — **that's a rescue, not help.**

The move instead:

Offer once. Then let go. "Do you want help with this, or do you just want me to listen?" — then honor the answer, even when it's hard to watch.

This week

Run the filter once, on something real. Notice what happens in your body when you don't jump in — that discomfort is the pattern, not a sign you did something wrong. It passes. That's the rep.

This is one of five tools.

The full workbook maps the whole pattern — the assessment, the engine underneath it, and the other four tools.

Come do the reps with people who get it: <https://www.skool.com/the-rescue-pattern-9645/about>